The 10 margin leaks of a hotel bar

Cheers Experiences checklist · Walk the bar in 20 minutes and tick what you find.

01 One pour too many. Margin too thin.

☐ Happens in my bar

Free pouring makes the cost of every drink unpredictable. The excess repeats, glass after glass.

How to fix it: Standardise measures and use a jigger.

02 High sales. Little left over.

☐ Happens in my bar

Without drink specifications, you may sell cocktails without knowing what each one really costs.

How to fix it: Calculate the full cost of every recipe.

03 Your neighbour's prices do not pay your bills.

☐ Happens in my bar

Copying prices ignores your costs, your service and the margin you need.

How to fix it: Set prices based on cost and the value you deliver.

04 Waste ends up on the bill too.

☐ Happens in my bar

Over-cut fruit, forgotten juices and excess prep add up to losses.

How to fix it: Prep to forecast demand and record waste.

05 Without stock counts, losses hide.

☐ Happens in my bar

Without matching stock to sales, over-pours, comps and breakages go unnoticed.

How to fix it: Count stock and compare actual usage with expected usage.

06 Idle bottles. Trapped cash.

☐ Happens in my bar

Buying products that barely sell ties up cash and takes up space.

How to fix it: Set purchasing and quantities by each product's rotation.

07 Does your menu know how to sell?

☐ Happens in my bar

Hiding high-margin, high-demand drinks wastes the potential of every order.

How to fix it: Highlight profitable choices with clear descriptions.

08 The team serves. But can it recommend?

☐ Happens in my bar

Simply taking orders leaves choices unexplored that guests would value.

How to fix it: Train relevant suggestions, with clear prices and no pressure.

09 Every minute of waiting can cost a sale.

☐ Happens in my bar

Poor prep and a disorganised station slow service at peak times.

How to fix it: Set up the station before opening and simplify movements.

10 The wrong shift costs money.

☐ Happens in my bar

Too many staff in quiet hours and too few at peaks raise costs and lose sales.

How to fix it: Match shifts to demand and to the tasks of each period.

Found two or more?

The Mystery Guest Bar Audit puts a euro figure on them and tells you what to fix first. Quoted per hotel. If the report does not identify monthly opportunities worth more than your investment in the diagnosis, we refund the fee.

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